GP FUTUREMAKERS 2026 · BUSINESS PLAN

AI Shopkeeper Assistant — Business Plan

For: GP FutureMakers 2026
Date: 13 October 2026
Stage: App built and tested. No paying customers yet.

> All prices are in Taka (৳) at ৳**123 = US$1**. AI costs are estimates based on the app's code and Google's published prices.

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1. Summary

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What it is	A shop app for Bangladesh's small grocery shops. The shopkeeper makes a sale by **speaking Bangla** or **pointing the camera**, and the app keeps stock, profit and customer credit (baki) up to date
Who pays	Busy shops that want faster, easier selling
Price	Free basic app. **Smart plan: ৳299 a month** (about ৳10 a day)
Cost to serve one paying shop	About **৳133 a month**
Money left per shop	About **৳166 a month (55%)**
Break-even	About **150 paying shops**
Year 3 target	10,000 paying shops, **৳2.15 crore revenue**, about **৳83.5 lakh profit**
Funding needed	About **৳2.5 lakh** to cover the pilot and the first year

2. The opportunity

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How many shops could use it?

	Number	Source
Small shops in Bangladesh	**1–4.5 million** (estimates vary)	Industry overview; ShopUp via Dhaka Tribune
Shops whose owner has a smartphone	**About 2–3 million**	73.4% of households own a smartphone (BBS via Dhaka Tribune)
Our 3-year target	**10,000 paying shops**	Less than 0.5% of these shops

Why now?

- **Shops must go digital.** Bangla QR payments became compulsory for all merchants on 1 July 2026, and 2.4 million merchants had signed up by August (The Observer).
- **AI is now cheap.** One AI-recorded sale costs about **৳0.20** once the app is optimised (see §4).
- **Typing is a barrier.** 42% of people are below fifth-grade literacy (Bonik Barta). A voice-first app reaches shopkeepers that typing apps miss.

3. What we sell

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Free plan. Stock list, sales, customer credit book, sales history, daily profit, and 30 AI sales a month to try voice and camera.

Smart plan (৳299 a month). Includes 600 AI voice or camera sales a month (20 a day). Paid by bKash or Nagad.

AI top-up. ৳40 for 100 extra AI sales, prepaid like a mobile recharge.

Why shops will pay: voice and camera make checkout faster, and the app shows real profit and who owes money. Collecting one forgotten ৳300 baki payment pays for the whole month.

4. Costs

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The app has three running costs.

4.1 AI cost per sale

Each voice or camera sale is one call to Google's Gemini AI. **Right now the app sends the shop's whole product list with every call, so bigger shops cost more:**

Shop size	Voice sale	Camera sale (now)	Camera sale (from Jan 2027)
100 products	৳0.27	৳0.38	৳0.76
300 products	৳0.44	৳0.77	৳1.54
1,000 products	৳1.06	৳2.13	৳4.25

Based on Google's prices (Gemini API pricing). The camera's AI model doubles in price on 1 January 2027.

The fix (a few days of work): send only the ~60 most likely products, and use Google's cheaper AI model for the camera too. Then **every AI sale costs about ৳0.20, whatever the shop size.**

This fix decides whether the business works:

Smart plan shop (600 AI sales a month)	AI cost	Money left from ৳299
With the fix	৳117	**+৳166 profit**
Without the fix, 300-item shop, now	৳364	**−৳81 loss**
Without the fix, 300-item shop, 2027	৳595	**−৳312 loss**

4.2 Server and internet

- **Server (Supabase): ৳3,075 a month** (US$25) covers thousands of shops, so it's under ৳10 per shop (pricing guide). The pilot can use the free plan.
- **Internet:** the shopkeeper uses their own phone data. 20 AI sales a day uses only about 100–200 MB a month.

5. Money per paying shop

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	৳ a month
Smart plan price	299
AI cost (600 sales at ৳0.195)	−117
Payment fee (about 2%)	−6
Server share	−10
Money left per shop	**166 (55%)**

6. Break-even

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Monthly fixed costs: about ৳25,000. That's the server (৳3,075), one part-time field agent plus marketing (৳20,000) and software tools (৳2,000). The founders are unpaid in year 1.

Break-even = fixed costs ÷ money left per shop.

Price	Money left per shop	Shops needed to break even
৳199	৳68	368
৳299	**৳166**	**151**
৳399	৳264	95

We chose ৳299. It's affordable (about ৳10 a day) and needs only about 150 shops to cover costs.

7. Three-year forecast

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	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Paying shops (end of year)	200	2,000	10,000
Revenue	৳3.6 lakh	৳39.5 lakh	৳2.15 crore
Money left after per-shop costs	৳2.0 lakh	৳21.9 lakh	৳1.2 crore
Fixed costs (team, marketing, server)	৳3.0 lakh	৳7.2 lakh	৳36 lakh
Profit / (loss)	**(৳1.0 lakh)**	**৳14.7 lakh**	**৳83.5 lakh**

Assumptions: ৳299 a month; shop numbers grow evenly through each year; fixed costs rise to ৳60,000 a month in year 2 and ৳3 lakh a month in year 3 (a team of about 8). These are plans, not guarantees.

8. Extra income (year 2 onwards)

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1. **Sponsored shops.** A distributor or brand pays the Smart plan for the shops it supplies, in return for anonymous sales trends.
2. **Loan referrals.** With the shopkeeper's permission, we share their sales record with a bank and earn a fee for each loan. Hishabee already does this with Prime Bank (Hishabee).
3. **Supplier orders.** When stock runs low, the app places a restock order with a wholesaler, and we take a small commission.

None of this is counted in the forecast above.

9. How we get customers

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Phase	When	Goal	How
Pilot	Months 0–3	50 shops using it free	Fix offline sales and AI cost first; sign up shops near campus; measure results
Launch	Months 3–12	200 paying shops	Show voice selling live at the counter; give a free month for each shop referred
Grow	Year 2+	2,000 → 10,000	Partner with distributors and banks; ask Grameenphone for a shop data pack

Grameenphone partnership ideas: a "Dokan data pack" for shopkeepers, selling AI top-ups through GP recharge, and using GP's retailer network for the pilot.

10. Competitors

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	What they offer	Our difference
TallyKhata	Free credit book and payments, 1 crore+ downloads, works offline (TallyKhata)	They need typing. We sell by **voice and camera**
Hishabee	Shop software plus stock loans up to ৳50,000 (Hishabee)	Typing-based. We could partner rather than compete
Paper khata	Free and familiar	No totals, no profit, no history

11. Risks

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Risk	What we do
AI cost too high	Make the AI-cost fix (§4.1) before charging anyone. Monthly AI limits plus prepaid top-ups mean no shop can cost more than it pays
Every sale needs internet (TallyKhata works offline)	Let normal sales save offline and sync later. Use AI only when online
Shops won't pay	Free plan first, then paid. A ৳199 plan still breaks even at 368 shops
AI gets a sale wrong	The shopkeeper confirms every AI sale before it's saved
Data protection law (2025)	Clear consent, a privacy policy, and a legal check on where data is stored (currently Tokyo)

12. What we need

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Item	Amount
Pilot (50 shops, 3 months: AI, travel, printed guides)	৳1.5 lakh
Year 1 loss (from §7)	৳1.0 lakh
Total	**About ৳2.5 lakh**

We'd also value mentorship on pricing, and a partnership with Grameenphone for data packs and pilot shops.

13. Social impact (short)

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- **Includes people who can't type:** voice and camera selling in Bangla.
- **Helps shops earn more:** they see real profit, keep stock and collect baki.
- **Opens access to loans:** a digital sales record can support a loan application. This matters most for women, whose businesses get only 7.28% of small-business loans against a 15% target (Dhaka Tribune).

Sources

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